

Sādhana of Tārā, the Bestower of Wealth

Dhanadhātṛ Sādhana · Toh 3207 · Derge Tengyur

སྒྲོམ་ནོར་སྒྱེ་མའ་སྒྲུ་བཅས།

Toh 3207 in the Tengyur is a sādhana text known in Sanskrit as the Dhanadhātṛ Sādhana and in Tibetan as the Sgrol ma nor sbyin ma'i sgrub thabs, meaning "The Sādhana of Tārā, the Bestower of Wealth." It is a ritual manual belonging to the class of tantric sādhana literature, prescribing a sequential meditation practice focused on Green Tārā in her wealth-bestowing aspect, together with the twelve goddesses of the speech maṇḍala associated with her. The text guides a yogin through the generation-stage visualization, beginning with the arousal of bodhicitta at dawn, the purification of body and speech, and the contemplation of the seed syllable TĀṂ at the heart center. As a sādhana, it belongs to the broader body of tantric practical instruction preserved in the Tengyur, the collection of Indian commentarial and related works translated into Tibetan.

In the language of India: Dhanadhātṛ Sādhana. In the Tibetan language: The Sādhana of Tārā, the Bestower of Wealth.

Homage to Tārā.

Tārā, green, with one face and four hands,
Possessed of two eyes, she who brings universal joy,
And the twelve goddesses of the wheel of the speech maṇḍala
Likewise each possess two eyes.

The supremely excellent and hard-to-find
Sādhana of the Blessed Lady, the noble Tārā,
In its sequential practice of Wealth-Bestowing Tārā —
I have well set forth here in brief.

At dawn, the yogin first generates the awakening mind. He then visualizes the blue syllable TĀṂ at his own heart center and performs the face-washing and other preliminary practices. He recites: "Om — because all phenomena are by nature thoroughly pure, I myself am thoroughly pure by nature." Then, with the words Om Amṛte Hūṃ Phaṭ, he swiftly cuts off all obstructors in the ten directions.

He then meditates on his own seed syllable, visualizing it resting upon a moon disk that has arisen from the syllable ĀṂ, which itself rests upon a red lotus that arose from the syllable PAṂ, all at his own heart center.

From that, rays of light radiate out and invite the guru, and the buddhas and bodhisattvas dwelling in space, to whom he makes excellent offerings. He then performs confession of wrongdoing and the other practices according to the ritual. He also meditates on emptiness and performs the blessing.

In the space before him, from the red syllable RA fully transformed, resting upon a sun disk, the black syllable HŪṂ arises, from which appears the multicolored vajra (viśvavajra). He then contemplates vajras radiating from it to form a vajra ground, a vajra fence, and a vajra tent.

Next, at the center of the multicolored vajra, he visualizes a red lotus arisen from the syllable PAṂ, upon which rests a moon disk arisen from the syllable A, upon which rests the white syllable BHRŪṂ — luminous and complete — fully transforming to become a white wheel with the syllable BHRŪṂ residing at its center.

The lotus, moon disk, wheel, and seed syllable all completely transform and from that arises a palace. This palace is made entirely of precious substances, endowed with qualities such as being four-sided and so forth. In the inner tier of the second rank, at its center, is the heart of an eight-petaled lotus, beautified by the crescent of a fresh moon, while the four sun disks dwelling at the four gates radiate great brilliance.

He then visualizes that very seed syllable upon the central moon disk. From it, rays of light radiate forth and are drawn back in. From that seed syllable he then meditates on himself as the Blessed Lady Tārā: she is seated upon a moon disk throne amidst rays of light, peaceful, in the posture of a bodhisattva with legs crossed. Her body is blue-green in color, with one face and two eyes and four hands, holding a rosary, making the gesture of supreme giving, and bearing an utpala lotus and a book. She is adorned with various ornaments and garments.

He then places the syllables of the mantra upon her body: Om̐ at the crown, TĀ at the forehead, RE at the two eyes, TU at the throat, TTĀ at the mouth, RE at the heart, TU at the navel, RE at the secret place, SVĀ at the two knees, and HĀ is placed at the two feet.

At the heart, the rays of light from the seed syllable resting upon the moon and lotus summon and invite the deity, and from the consecration bestowed by the goddesses beginning with the eye goddess (Locanā) and the others, the crown of Amoghasiddhi is to be visualized upon her.

Then, upon the moon disks dwelling in the outer rank, the goddesses — Vajra Tārā and the others — are visualized in an instant. In the outer visualization they appear as follows: in the east, Vajra Tārā, black, holding a vajra in her hand; in the south, Ratna Tārā, yellow, holding a jewel in her hand; in the west, Padma Tārā, red, holding a red lotus in her hand; in the north, Buddha Tārā, white, holding a wheel in her hand.

At the fire corner stands Flower Tārā, white, holding a garland of flowers. At the southwest corner stands Incense Tārā, black, holding an incense vessel in her hand. At the wind corner stands Lamp Tārā, yellow, holding a lamp vessel in her hand. At the corner of the Powerful One stands Perfume Tārā, red, holding a conch of perfume in her hand. These goddesses are to be visualized upon the moon disks that rest on the petals of the multicolored lotus. All eight are endowed with the radiance of the moon, seated in the bodhisattva posture, holding an utpala lotus in the left hand, smiling, and adorned with various ornaments and garments.

At the eastern gate stands Vajra Hook, black, holding a vajra hook in her hand. At the south stands Vajra Lasso, yellow, holding a vajra lasso in her hand. At the west stands Vajra Chain, red, holding a vajra chain in her hand. At the north stands Vajra Bell, white, holding a vajra bell in her hand. These four at the four gates are to be visualized upon sun disks. They are endowed with the blazing splendor of the sun; their yellow hair blazes upward; they stand with the left leg drawn in; they are adorned with snakes and their faces are wrathful; they wear a skirt of tiger skin; and their left hands hold an utpala lotus.

Then, having united the wisdom being with the oneself-being, one meditates with a perfectly still mind upon one's own seed syllable, exceedingly subtle, resting on the lotus at one's own heart center, and recites the mantra: Oṃ tāre tuttāre ture dhana me da da svāhā.

At the time of rising from that session, one performs the torma offering with the mantra beginning "Oṃ akāro mukhaṃ" and so forth, together with the mudrā of the utpala lotus, and also makes aspiration prayers. Then, having dissolved the divine maṇḍala back into one's own seed syllable, one moves about as one pleases while maintaining the form of the deity.

For the sessions of midday and afternoon, one instantly radiates the divine maṇḍala outward from the seed syllable at one's own heart center, and then, just as before, engages in meditation, recitation, and the rest.

For the sessions of the late afternoon and midnight, the special distinction is as follows: one thoroughly makes offering to the wisdom maṇḍala with flowers and so forth, and then dismisses the maṇḍala with this mantra: Oṃ tāre tuttāre ture muḥ.

This concludes the sādhana of Tārā, the Bestower of Wealth. By the great paṇḍita Abha—

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "the crown of Amoghasiddhi" follows the standard identification in Tārā sādhana literature where Amoghasiddhi (here appearing via the epithet "Amoghasiddhi's crown," don yod grub pa'i cod pan) consecrates Tārā as belonging to his buddha family. This is the standard initiation-crown imagery.

The compound translated "eye goddess (Locanā)" renders spyān ma, which in the context of Tārā sādhana refers specifically to the offering goddess Locanā who leads the group of empowering goddesses. This is a technical sādhana context and not the generic word for "eye."

The opening bibliographic lines are in the standard Tibetan canonical format (language of composition, then Tibetan title) and are translated accordingly rather than as part of the literary text.

- The text breaks off mid-name at the end, indicating the colophon is incomplete in this passage. The full name of the paṇḍita author begins "Abha—" which almost certainly refers to Abhayākaragupta or a similar figure, but the manuscript truncates here.

The phrase rendered "corner of the Powerful One" translates a directional term associated with Īśāna, the deity of the northeast in the traditional Indic directional schema. The four intercardinal goddesses correspond to the standard offering goddesses of the maṇḍala system.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.